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Author: Theophilus Cibber

Author of introduction, etc.: Mary F. Klinger

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE HARLOT'S
PROGRESS (1733), THE RAKE'S PROGRESS (MS., CA. 1778-1780) ***

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THE
HARLOT'S PROGRESS

THEOPHILUS CIBBER

(1733)

and

THE
RAKE'S PROGRESS

(MS., Ca. 1778-1780)

Introduction by
MARY F. KLINGER

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INTRODUCTION

The prints and engraved sequences of William Hogarth (1697-1764) inspired a wide range of dramatic entertainments throughout the eighteenth century. The types include comedy of manners (*The Clandestine Marriage*, 1766), burletta with *tableau vivant* (*Ut Pictura Poesis!* 1789), specialty act (*A Modern Midnight Conversation*, 1742), cantata (*The Roast Beef of Old England*, ca. 1759), ballad opera (*The Decoy*), ^[1] pantomime (*The Jew Decoy'd* and *The Harlot's Progress*, 1733), and a morality ballad opera (*The Rake's Progress*, ca. 1778-1780). Two of these are reprinted here. Theophilus Cibber's "Grotesque Pantomime Entertainment" of Hogarth's six-scene series "A Harlot's Progress" (1732), entitled *THE HARLOT'S PROGRESS*; or *The Ridotto Al'Fresco*,^[2] was first published 31 March 1733 for its Drury Lane debut as an afterpiece. ^[2] Less familiar is the anonymous "Dramatised Version" of Hogarth's eight-print sequence "A Rake's Progress" (1735), British Library Add. MS. 25997, entitled *The Rake's Progress*. ^[3]

Of critical interest in looking at the engravings along with the dramas they inspired is the evidence provided of significant visual-verbal reciprocities in the period. In particular, it shows one aspect of the interrelationship operative between (1) creation of the prints, with the artist often relying perceptibly on dramatic literature and theatrical sets, ^[4] and (2) inspiration from print to theater, as playwrights generated new stage pieces based on the graphic works. Moreover, these two dramas underscore the importance of music in eighteenth century theater where the use of songs in pantomimes and new lyrics for old tunes in ballad opera were alike commonplace by mid-century. ^[5] The plays lend support to Bertrand Bronson's observation that, in an age which "thought Man the proper study of Mankind," it is not surprising that the "major emphasis (and accomplishment) in music should be dramatic and, in a broad sense, social." ^[6] These dramas add visual and musical insights to literary concerns of the time.

In "A Harlot's Progress" (1732) Hogarth's six prints recount a few years in the young life of "M. Hackabout" from her innocent arrival in London (from Yorkshire) through debauchery, prostitution, and theft to death from venereal disease at the age of 23. Hogarth's engraved sequence shows about 12 characters, including Moll's child and supernumerary harlots at her funeral. The stage piece by Colley Cibber's son entitled *The Harlot's Progress* consists solely of stage directions and verses set to six "Airs." It has 27 characters, including a "little Harlequin Dog." The harlot's new name, "Kitty," probably refers to the actress (Mrs. Raftor, later Kitty Clive) who initially played this role. The music for the songs seems to be lost, though many tunes can be identified. ^[7] Furthermore, Roger Fiske reports that later in 1733 this work was offered at Bartholomew Fair with a band that included "oboes, bassoons, horns, trumpets, drums and strings." Though traditionally *The Harlot's Progress* has been treated as pantomime, Fiske considers it a "mixture of masque, ballad opera and pantomime." ^[8] Actually Cibber's piece, with its concluding "Masque," more closely fits Paul Sawyer's definition of pantomime as "a mixture of comic (sometimes called grotesque) elements" concerning the love adventures and misadventures of Harlequin and Columbine, "largely in dumb show," but "occasionally interspersed with songs and dances." ^[9] In addition, Sawyer notes, there is a "serious part," usually drawn from mythology, featuring dancing, recitative, song, and some dialogue. In the present case, this would be the masque of "The Judgment of Paris" which concludes *The Harlot's Progress* (p. 12).

On the stage, Cibber shifts the Hogarthian tone from an ineluctable moral formula (the wages of sin equal death) to one that transforms social and moral punishment into lyrical pageantry. To accomplish this, he uses the mechanical humor of harlequinade and omits three grim occasions portrayed by Hogarth: Hackabout's apprehension by Sir John Gonson in a garret (Pl. 4), her early death from venereal disease (Pl. 5), and her funeral with its morally dubious mourners (Pl. 6). Cibber replaces the potential moral commentary of these three prints with stage antics and dance. Cibber's harlot "Kitty" is sent to Bridewell like Hogarth's Moll Hackabout (Pl. 4), but her punishment there turns magically into a dance.

The "Keeper" forces her and other women to beat hemp, but the blocks suddenly disappear; in their stead appear her lover Harlequin, with Scaramouch and others, and all "dance off" to the "Ridotto al'Fresco," while the Keeper "runs away frightened." The threat of punishment vanishes with the blocks. At the "Ridotto," in a stage set depicting a Vauxhall scene, people appear in masquerade, and a grand "Comic Ballad" is performed to various musical tunes. But this is not the end of the pantomime, for yet to come is "The Judgment of Paris," John Weaver's "Dramatic Entertainment" after the "Manner of the Ancient Greeks and Romans," which had premiered in February 1733. ^[10]

Though he was quite consciously imitating Hogarth's "Celebrated Designs," Cibber's directions do not specify that costuming duplicate Hogarth's contemporary London figures such as the notorious Mother Needham, Colonel Charteris (Pl. 1), Justice Gonson (Pl. 4), or the quarreling doctors Misaubin and Rock at Moll's deathbed (Pl. 5). ^[11] In addition to changing the name "M. Hackabout" to "Kitty" the "Country Girl," Cibber dubs his Charteris character "Old Debauchee," Needham "Madame Decoy," and the Jew who keeps Kitty, "Beau Mordecai."

The comic element asserts itself in the first stage scene as Harlequin hides in Kitty's trunk and then disguises himself as a cadet, imitating Hackabout's lover in Hogarth's second print. During this stage trick, Madame Decoy sings new verses to an eighteenth century ballad celebrating the innocent beauties of rural poverty (Air I, "What tho' I am a Country Lass"). Clearly, audiences familiar with the more biting pictorial scenes of a harlot's life would be easily diverted, even relieved, by the elaborate mixture of Greek and Italian elements, and the flourish of songs in the parodic ballad opera tradition. Cibber of course capitalized on the occasion, popularity, and familiarity of Hogarth's six prints in 1733, but his theatrical realization clarifies the quality of pantomimic entertainment with its numerous contemporary graphic allusions, revealing an aborted moral embellished by a splay of music and masque.

Theophilus Cibber's entertainment was quite successful on the London stage, having a good run at the patent theaters and the fairs in 1733 and for a while thereafter. ^[12] Furthermore, it is related to an important event in

Drury Lane history. Cibber seceded with a group of actors in May of 1733 from that theater because of management disputes. After playing at the fairs, the protesting actors performed at the Little Theatre in the Haymarket until the spring of 1734 when they returned to Drury Lane. In a letter to patentee John Highmore, Cibber wrote of the *Harlot's Progress*: "This entertainment (for which I am indebted to Mr. Hogarth's designs) the Town were pleased to approve of and encourage." But, he adds, it might have been performed "three months sooner than it was, but for the Obstructions I met with from my Partners." ^[13] This theatrical quarrel created much public discussion in the first decade of the century (*LS*, 3, 1, "Introduction," *passim*). Hogarth included in his print "Southwark Fair" (which came out after August 1733) a showcloth of John Laguerre's engraving "The Stage Mutiny," a print that in turn had been inspired by the actors' secession. Hogarth's additions to the Laguerre print demonstrate his close touch with these events (*HGW*, I, 156-7). ^[14] *The Harlot's Progress* provides us with a good example of the genre "Grotesque Pantomime," and throws much light on the London stage entertainment stream of an evening that included Hogarth, harlequin, Venus and Paris, as well as dancing and singing.

Hogarth's eight prints of "A Rake's Progress" of 1735 ^[15] provided the subject—the rise and fall of a libertine—for a morality ballad opera more than forty years later. The 15-scene stage piece, entitled *The Rake's Progress*, elaborates visually and musically the formula: follow virtue and avoid vice. The author clearly counted on audience familiarity with the graphic scenes many years after their appearance, and on an increased receptivity to explicit moralizing. This manuscript was submitted by the unknown playwright to Drury Lane sometime between September 1778 and June 1780. The possible date is most clearly focused in the Sheridans' joint management. Richard assumed the management in 1776 and held it to at least 1809, but his father Thomas managed it with his son only for the seasons 1778-1779 and 1779-1780. ^[16] I think it is therefore possible to suggest a date for the manuscript between September 1778 when Thomas Sheridan came to Drury Lane, and the end of the 1779-1780 theatrical season, when he left at the age of 61. ^[17] The piece was not performed.

Like the Cibber work, the text consists of stage directions and songs. Allusions to Hogarth appear in title, characters, plot, and specific scenes.

Moreover, a "transparency" introduces the artist in a literal stage portrait. This device praises Hogarth and reminds the audience of the graphic correspondences in dramatic form to come.

The Rake's Progress makes significant changes in the content of Hogarth's series, expanding characters and scenes, and altering the denouement somewhat from madness to suicide. New elements of music and clowning change his lugubrious didacticism to a lyrical warning in a form I call "morality ballad opera." The morality and masque features appear in such characters as "Virtue" and "Vice" who frame the piece, and "Liberty" and "Benevolence" who descend and ascend on a cloud, at the end taking Virtue with them. Not included in the theater version is Hogarth's depiction of the harsh realities of Bethlehem Hospital, or Bedlam, where spectators pay to gawk at the inmates, and where Rakewell's libertine journey ends dismally (Pl. 8). On the boards, the didacticism is even more emphatic. Rakewell shoots himself to background music which slows in tempo until it is "render'd as dismal as possible" and Virtue proclaims a triumph over the demonstrated "baneful influence of Vice."

In "A Rake's Progress" (1735), Hogarth depicts an inverse relationship between morality and the misuse of money. In the first of the eight prints, young Tom Rakewell inherits wealth from his miserly father and misspends it for the remainder of his life in copying the lifestyle of an aristocrat. His moral poverty is evident as he offers money to the mother of pregnant Sarah Young, his former girlfriend, who stands disconsolately poisoning a wedding ring. Letters containing his false promises to her clarify the situation. Material wealth is the cornerstone of this series as we next see the rake being measured by a tailor for new clothes while a lawyer pilfers cash; and an upholsterer's hammering to ready the room for mourning results in a shower of previously hidden gold coins (Pl. 1). The levee (Pl. 2) shows Rakewell in a fashionable morning gown, courted by a gardener, huntsman, and others, while a list of gifts from the nobility to opera star Farinelli includes a snuff box from Rakewell. His nocturnal taste shows in the Rose Tavern where he carouses and is himself raked by harlots (Pl. 3). As part of this debauched ambiance, a pregnant woman sings the bawdy ballad "Black Joke." In daylight, the faithful Sarah saves Rakewell from street arrest while a group of gamblers fills out the visual exposition of the rake's

dissipation (Pl. 4). Saved by the middle class girl he ruined, Rakewell next weds a rich widow to recoup his losses. Sarah, her mother, and Rakewell's infant offspring unsuccessfully try to abort this clandestine wedding (Pl. 5). Rakewell's marriage of convenience cannot meet his needs, and he soon rails despairingly in a Covent Garden gambling house (Pl. 6). The juggernaut of vice presses on as he is jailed for debt in Fleet Street prison where he runs up more bills. A prisoner drops a "Scheme for paying y^e Debts of y^e Nation" to the floor as Sarah faints away and Rakewell's wife scolds (Pl. 7). The social nadir of Bedlam illumines darkly Rakewell's last loss—his reason—and this graphic anti-progress concludes, as it began, with Sarah's sorrow (Pl. 8).

What did the playwright do with Hogarth's harsh comment on the misappropriation of inherited wealth? He seems to have enhanced entertainment values and emphasized instruction at the same time. The drama embellishes the series by (a) adding stage links only imaginable by spectators of the print sequences, (b) framing the progress with a morality masque starring Virtue and Vice, and (c) replacing Hogarth's serious ironic tone with slapstick and songs drawn from stage musical fare, such as the burletta *Poor Vulcan!* by Charles Dibdin, which premiered in February 1778 (*LS*, 5, I, 109). Basically, Hogarth's eight prints of 1735 are transformed in part into a series of *tableaux vivants* which served, with variations, in the late 1770's as strong visual reminders for an audience already familiar with the original pictorial sequence.

For example, directions for the second scene attempt to put on the boards the initial print, adding music and slapstick as "money from the raftor falls into Clown's mouth." The play invites the spectator to follow Sarah and her mother after they leave Rakewell and listen to their duet, sung to the music of Air I of *The Beggar's Opera*. The lyrics change, so that Peachum's cynical comment "Through all the employments of life/Each neighbor abuses his brother" becomes "His vows, ah! Why did'st thou believe?/He ne'er meant a promise to keep," with the new association of Sarah's being cast off by Rakewell.

The drama closely follows the series for the rake's levee, where professionals "pay Court" to Rakewell. A new character, "Van Butchel,"

who sings in dialect, is added. The opportunism of those proffering services to the young man becomes clear in their musical medley when they announce they will "plunder him as fast as we can agree." At the Rose Tavern, stage directions for Rakewell state "the actor must let his intoxication gradually increase." Before Rakewell's arrest, the bailiff sings a solo. Sarah saves her lover, as in the sequence, but a small revelation of his character not in the print marks the incident: he "kisses her hand" before returning to his sedan chair.

The stage piece exploits the potential emotional element in such gestures to the point of sentimentality. For instance, Sarah's lament following Rakewell's marriage to the rich "Old Woman" shows grief driving her to despair; she sings "The Grave will extinguish my woes/Then Sarah—prepare thee to die" to the music of the seventeenth century ballad tune "Mary's Lamentation." The drama also exploits the sensational as the smoking fire in a Covent Garden gambling house (Hogarth's Pl. 5) becomes a public catastrophe with fire engines and furniture being carried into the street and "Confusion kept up as long as necessary."

In the jail scene, the rake turns out of his breeches a "Scheme to Pay the National Debt," a specific verbal echo of the Fleet Street print, and the prisoners sing a familiar tune ("Welcome, Brother Debtor") as musical background to his off-stage suicide. Then Virtue returns to ascend with "Liberty and Benevolence" on a cloud, able to relax now that Vice's influence has run its destructive course.

The Rake's Progress is an essentially uneven dramatic work. The playwright colors the didacticism of Hogarth's prints with music and farce, yet underscores it by adding Virtue and Vice and the melodrama of Rakewell's suicide and Sarah's probable death. The author capitalizes on the suspense of choice, characteristic of the morality play, by dramatizing it in conflicts between Vice and Virtue. Yet the effect remains unbalanced. This palpable form of Hogarth's visual satire loses much of its impact without a balance of serious, comic, and musical ingredients. Furthermore, the musical elements are so haphazardly distributed that they often contribute to a patchwork effect, as when the bailiff sings a solo prior to making an arrest.

Although *The Rake's Progress* purports to imitate Hogarth's "Comedy," where a "beginning, middle & an End/ Are Aptly join'd; where parts on parts depend,/ Each made for each, as Bodies for their Soul," the 15 scenes alternate too erratically between humor and melodrama to convey the artistic unity and moral conviction evident in the pictorial sequence. But this stage piece does demonstrate the persistence of Hogarth's visual presence in later eighteenth-century life along with the adaptability of his graphic scenes for the London theater.

Clearly Theophilus Cibber's comical, lyrical exploitation in *The Harlot's Progress* of Hogarth's designs exhibits a more coherent dramatic structure than the tentative, disjointed medley of music and moralism in *The Rake's Progress*. Further, Cibber's piece adds literary insight to our concept of the hardly dumb genre of pantomime, with its musical and masque components. The added melodrama and sentimentality in *The Rake's Progress* can help to index theatrical taste in the later period. For students of the century, both works demonstrate clearly an aspect of the reliance on Hogarth's art by playwrights. They also show the flexibility of the London stage in the use of elements of music and dance to link separate print scenes, and so attempt a bridge between the forms of art and drama. These two examples of the lively interplay operative between stage and print in the early and late decades heighten appreciation of the expectancies of cultural experiences of different audiences in the eighteenth century.

THE TUNES

The Harlot's Progress and *The Rake's Progress* are alike interesting for the parodic ballad opera pattern of setting new words to familiar tunes. Though neither work includes the music, some songs indicate familiar melodies such as "Let us take the road" from *The Beggar's Opera*. In *The Harlot's Progress*, the six "Airs" come from varied sources, with new lyrics by Theophilus Cibber. Of the approximately 24 unnumbered tunes and catches in *The Rake's Progress*, the most outstanding in connection with the print sequence is "Black Joke," Richard Leveridge's bawdy tune shown by Hogarth in the Rose Tavern print being sung by a pregnant woman (Pl. 5). In the stage piece, this song is part of a medley sung to Rakewell by the various professionals who compete for his money. The most important

tunes are those from *Poor Vulcan!* the burletta by Charles Dibdin (February 1778), supporting my 1778-1780 date for *The Rake's Progress* manuscript.

The sources used to trace the musical airs include Claude Simpson's *The British Broadside Ballad and Its Music* (New Brunswick: Rutgers University Press, 1966); Minnie Sears' *Song Index* (and *Supplement*) (New York: Wilson Company, 1926 and 1934); Edythe N. Backus: *Catalogue of Music Printed Before 1801* (San Marino, Cal.: The Huntington Library, 1949), and William Barclay Squire, "An Index of Tunes in the Ballad-Operas," *The Musical Antiquary*, II (October 1910), 1-17. ^[18] E. V. Roberts points out that "the lack of a ballad designation for a ballad-opera air usually means that the tune in question was composed specially for that ballad opera" and that, because most "unnamed tunes were unknown outside their ballad operas," they were "neither copied nor printed, and simply do not turn up in the collections." ^[19] The catches in *The Rake's Progress* are not traceable. The numbering for songs in *The Rake's Progress* is my own. Airs from both plays give us some idea of the rich musical treasure English stagewriters could draw upon for theatrical offerings in the eighteenth century. ^[20]

THE HARLOT'S PROGRESS

Air I: "What tho I am a Country Lass" is an eighteenth century ballad by Martin Parker printed in *Orpheus Calendonius; or, A Collection of Scots Songs Set to Music by W[illiam] Thomson*, II (London 1733), p. 85. Its first two lines are "Although I be but a Country Lass/Yet a lofty Mind I bear-a." It was used by Theophilus Cibber (as Air XII) in his 1732 one-act version of Charles Coffey's *The Devil to Pay* where the transformed cobbler's wife Nell sings: "Tho late I was a Cobler's Wife,/In cottage most obscure-a" (pp. 20-21). In *The Harlot's Progress*, this air, sung by Madame Decoy, is clearly appropriate for seducing Kitty-Moll into the world of bawds and prostitutes, with its theme of magical change and the conquest of innocence by vice.

Air II: "Brisk Tom and Jolly Kate" is Air IX of Lacy Ryan's *The Cobler's Opera* (London 1729), which has tunes by Leveridge, Purcell, and others. The lyrics in Ryan's piece allude to Bridewell: "Pray; Sir, did I not give to you a Passage free/When Hemp did threaten," (pp. 14-15).

Air III: "Maggy Lawther" is a tune used by Theophilus Cibber (Air IX) in *Patie and Peggy ... A Scotch Ballad Opera* (London 1730), p. 10.

Air IV: "Oh! what Pleasures will abound" is Air VII of Henry Fielding's *The Lottery* (London 1732). Johann Pepusch composed the music for this air in collaboration with Lewis Theobald for the pantomime opera *Perseus and Andromeda* (1730). Fielding's name for the tune was "In Perseus and Andromeda."

Air V: "Lads a Dunce." The music is preserved in British Library Add. MS. 29371, fol. 30a, no. 45, and printed in Fielding's *The Grub-Street Opera* as Air II (ed. Edgar V. Roberts, Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 1968), p. 92. Its composer is not known.

Air VI: "Maidens fresh as a Rose" appears as Air VI in Ebenezer Forrester's ballad opera *Momus turn'd fabulist; or, Vulcan's Wedding*, a work translated from the French of Fuzelier and Le Grand (London 1729), p. 12. It also could be the song in D'Urfey's *Wit and Mirth: or, Pills to Purge Melancholy* (1719), with a slightly different title, "Maiden fresh as a Rose," though the syllabic pattern does not seem to match: "Young buxome and full of jollity,/Take no Spouse among Beaux," (I, p. 57).

THE RAKE'S PROGRESS

Airs I-III are not traceable ("From Virue's sluggish Rules be free," "Mary's Dream" and "Alteration").

Air IV: "Duett" to the tune "An Old Woman Cloathed in Gray" is the familiar first tune of John Gay's *The Beggar's Opera*, ed. Edgar V. Roberts (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 1969), pp. 94-95.

Air V: Van Butchel's song ("See Martin dus his goods display") is not in the songbooks. Prof. Roberts suggests the lyrics could fit the music of "Lillibullero," sometimes used for songs in dialect. Henry Purcell wrote or arranged this Irish burden which was used in 12 ballad operas, including Fielding's *Don Quixote in England* (1733). Simpson (p. 454) gives one example in dialect: "By Creist my dear Morish vat makes de sho'shad" (ca. 1689).

Air VI: "Shelah O'Sudds" (to the tune "The Siege of Troy") is not traceable.

Air VII: "Medley. Tune, 'Petition Poor Vulcan'" is from Charles Dibdin's burletta *Poor Vulcan!* (London 1778) which begins: "The humble prayer and petition/Of Vulcan, who his sad condition" (I, 1, p. 7).

Air VIII: "Tune. Hunting Chorus, 'Poor Vulcan'" is the "Chorus and Air" from Dibdin's *Poor Vulcan!* It begins: "Blacksmith: 'Strike, strike, ton, ton ton, ron'/Huntsman: 'Sound, Sound, tan, ran, ran, tan'" (I, ii, p. 10).

Air IX: "Tune: 'Finale 1st act *Poor Vulcan!*'" seems to be the song "Pike; 'Pooltroon! Damnation! Zounds, unhand me;/ Either you villain, eat that word,'" (*Poor Vulcan!* I, p. 23).

Air X: "Medley. Tune, 'Black Joke'" is Leveridge's song of 1730. See E. V. Roberts, ed. Henry Fielding, *The Grub-Street Opera* (p. 105) and Charles Wood's *The Author's Farce* (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press, 1966), p. 116.

Air XI: "Welcome, Brother Debtor" appears in many eighteenth-century song collections, including Henry Roberts' *Calliope; or,*

English Harmony, a collection of ... English and Scots tunes (London, 1739-1749), p. 315.

Airs XII, XIII and XIV are not traceable. ("Medley tunes 'Stoney Batter,' 'Tyburn Tree,' and 'Ballance a Straw.'")

Air XV: "Bailiff's Song" has no tune and is not traceable.

Air XVI: "Mind the Golden Rule" is not identifiable.

Air XVII: "Tune 'Mary's Lamentation'" is the old ballad (set to the music of "Crimson Velvet"), the "lamentable complaint" of Queen Mary for the "unkind departure" of King Philip, "in whose absence she fell sick, and died," which begins "Mary doth complain;/Ladies be you moved," and appears in Richard Johnson's *Crown Garland of Roses* (1659), ed. Chappell, 1895. Though popular in the seventeenth century, it may have been written soon after Queen Mary's death in 1558 (Simpson, p. 141). Verses similar to *Air XVII* ("I Sigh and lament me in vain,/These Walls can but echo my moan,") appeared in Signior Giordani's "Queen Mary's Lamentation," printed in Domenico Corri's *Select Collection* of 1779 (III, No. 71).

Air XVIII: The "Clown's Song" seems to have been specially composed for this work.

Air XIX: "Tune: 'Let us take the Road'" is the famous "March in Rinaldo" by Handel. See *Air XX, The Beggar's Opera* (Act II, ed. Roberts, pp. 130-131).

Air XX: "Ballad Tune: 'The Race Horse'" with the title "The Rake's Progress." Thomas D'Urfey's tune is called "The Race Horse," and begins "To Horse, brave Boys of Newmarket, to Horse," and is "set to an excellent Scotch tune" called "Cock up thy Beaver" (Simpson, p. 112). It was first published with the music in D'Urfey's *Choice New Songs* (1684) and appears as an untitled air in Kane O'Hara's comic opera *Midas* (1764; ARS 167). It is also called "Newmarket," or "Newmarket Horse

Race," Air XXII of the 1730 and 1750 versions of Fielding's *The Author's Farce*. The music is printed in Woods's edition of *The Author's Farce*, p. 133.

California State University
Northridge

NOTES TO THE INTRODUCTION

[1] There are at least three dramatic pieces other than the *Theophilus Cibber* work reprinted here which were inspired by William Hogarth's "A Harlot's Progress." Ronald Paulson reports one announced in the *Daily Advertiser* (13 November 1732) by Charlotte Charke entitled *The Harlot*. It had been printed by Curll; but there is no record of performance (*Hogarth: His Life, Art, and Times*, I, London and New Haven: Yale University Press, 1971, p. 290). Paulson also mentions the publication announcement in the *Daily Advertiser* (5 February 1732/3) of: "*The Decoy, or The Harlot's Progress* (on February 14 called *The Jew Decoy'd*), a new ballad opera, said to be performed at Goodman's Fields" (p. 290). *The Jew Decoy'd*, a work never performed and discussed at length by Robert E. Moore (*Hogarth's Literary Relationships*, Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1948, pp. 34-36) as being published in 1733, is a different piece than *The Decoy; or, The Harlot's Progress, A New Ballad Opera* [By Henry Potter] (*The London Stage*, ed. Arthur Scouten, Part 3, Vol. I, Carbondale: Southern Illinois University Press, 1962-68, pp. 269-270, abbreviated in later citations as "LS" followed by part, volume and page number.) The title page of Potter's piece reads: "*The Decoy. An Opera. As it is Acted at the New Theatre in Goodman's Fields*. London, 1733, with the "Dedication" signed by Potter. This three-act piece contains 52 songs, three of which also appear in Cibber's "The Harlot's Progress." The "Introduction" alludes to Hogarth's series as the source ("the Sketch is now in Print"), but it has many links to John Gay's *The Beggar's Opera*, and, like Cibber's piece, only follows the first three plates. Potter's small theater in the Haymarket opened in 1720 but no organized company had produced legitimate drama there by 1728 (LS, 3, I, cxxxix). The run was successful for Potter: he had a benefit on 8 February, with the comment "On account of the great Demand for Places, the Pit and Boxes will be laid together at 5s each" (LS 3, I, 270). Hogarth had advertised the subscription for "A Harlot's Progress" as early as 8 March 1731. (See Ronald Paulson, *Hogarth's Graphic Works*, I, Rev. Ed., New Haven and London: Yale University Press, 1970, p. 141. Citations in my text are abbreviated HGW followed by volume and page number.) This piece appears in Baker's *Biographia Dramatica* (Vol. II, p. 157) without comment, while he lists "*The Jew Decoy'd; or The Progress of an Harlot*," 8vo. 1733 "as never being performed, but founded on the Hogarth

series." *The Jew Decoy'd* discussed by Moore has the title page: "London: Printed for E: Rayner ... 1733," published on 14 February (p. 34). The Henry E. Huntington Library has a copy, "Printed by W: Rayner ... 1735" but does not have the frontispiece Moore describes. For engravings, see Vol. II of Paulson's *Hogarth's Graphic Works*.

[2] Reprinted here with permission of the Henry E. Huntington Library (No. 151783). There are two other extant copies of the first edition: one in the Boston Public Library and the other in the British Library. The British Library copy has two inserted engraved portraits (Theophilus Cibber in his role of Pistol, and Hogarth seated at an easel studying a cartoon of a goddess, probably based on "Hogarth Painting the Comic Muse" of 1758). Yale University has a photostat facsimile of the Boston Public Library edition. I thank David Rodes for looking at the British Library copy.

[3] Reprinted here in typescript form from a manuscript difficult to reproduce legibly. The work is anonymous. The typescript appeared as "Appendix I" of my unpublished New York University dissertation on William Hogarth with permission of the Trustees of the British Library. I have discussed it in "*The Rake's Progress: A New Dramatic Version of William Hogarth's Prints*," in *Notes and Queries* (October 1972), 381-383. The theatrical career of the author, Theophilus Cibber (1703-1758), has not been fully assessed. He did know Hogarth: they both belonged to John Rich's group, the "Sublime Society of Beef Steaks," which met in the scene-painting loft over the Covent Garden stage. Cibber joined the group in September 1739, and Hogarth was a charter member in 1735 (*HGW*, I, 188). Cibber himself played an active role in the creation of the position of stage manager or "under-manager" (*LS*, 3, I, xcvi).

[4] See my essay concerning such connections, in "William Hogarth and London Theatrical Life," *Studies in Eighteenth Century Culture*, Vol. 5, ed. R. Rosbottom (Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 1975), 11-31.

[5] See my "Music and Theatre in Hogarth," *The Musical Quarterly*, 57 (July 1971), 409-426.

[6] "Some Aspects of Music and Literature," repr. *Facets of the Enlightenment* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1968), p. 92.

[7] See "The Tunes" at end of Introduction.

[8] *English Theatre Music in the Eighteenth Century* (London: Oxford University Press, 1973), p. 108.

[9] "The Popularity of Various Types of Entertainment at Lincoln's Inn Fields and Covent Garden Theatres, 1720-1733," *Theatre Notebook*, XXIV: 4 (Summer 1970), 156.

[10] The complete title is "*The Judgment of Paris. A Dramatic Entertainment In Dancing and Singing, After the Manner of the Ancient Greeks and Romans. As it is Perform'd at the Theatre-Royal in Drury Lane*," with words by Congreve, music by Seedo and "Compos'd by J. Weaver, Dancing-Master." This work had its Drury Lane debut 6 February 1733, and *The London Stage* entry for 31 March

1733 reads: "John Banks's *The Albion Queens* ... Also *The Harlot's Progress*; or, *the Triumph of Beauty*" (LS, 3, I, 283). Many actors and actresses doubled (e.g., Mrs. Raftor is one of the "Graces" in the masque). No doubt the concluding "Masque" of *The Harlot's Progress* is Weaver's piece (p. 12).

[11] Paulson (HGW, I, 148) describes these two doctors, "well known for their quack cures for venereal disease." Dr. Rock's name was added by Hogarth in a later state of the print.]

[12] Cibber's piece may have opened as early as 12 March 1733 in the pantomime house at Sadler's Wells, which had been reconstructed from a seventeenth century Music Room (see LS, 3, I, xxxix). Cibber's *The Harlot's Progress* had a successful run at Drury Lane in the spring of 1733, from 31 March until 28 May, when the actor-manager dispute led to a closing of the playhouse (see LS, 3, I, 304). It played as an afterpiece to such works as *Cato* and *The Provok'd Husband*, and on 26 April a playbill announced the "Royal Family expected to attend" (LS, 3, I, 293). Thereafter it had a career at the fairs, beginning with the Lee-Harper-Petit Booth on Tottenham Court on 30 August 1733 (LS, 3, I, 310), moving on 23 August to Bartholomew Fair and on 28 September to Mile End Green, where the harlot's name is listed as "Moll Hackabout" (LS, 3, I, 321). On 27 October 1733 it had a command performance at Drury Lane (LS, 3, I, 330). It played frequently during that winter and in the spring, on 26 April, the seceding actors returned to Drury Lane to perform in *The Conscious Lovers* and *The Harlot's Progress*. The cast list is the same as that in the text reprinted here (LS, 3, I, 390). The successful run continued through October 1734; after that it was only played a couple of times before the 1736 season (LS, 3, I, *passim*). Scouten observes: "a remarkable feature" is that this piece "places a Jewish merchant in a favorable light, treating him not with sympathy but with respect as a pillar of trade" (LS, 3, I, xcvi).

[13] "A Letter from Theo. Cibber, Comedian, To John Highmore, Esq." (London 1733).

[14] Hogarth reversed Laguerre's print, adding the banner "We eat," the label "Pistol's alive" under Theophilus Cibber's feet and the phrase "Quiet and Snug" under Colley Cibber. For descriptions of the rebellion, see John Genest, *Some Account of the English Stage from the Restoration in 1660 to 1830*, III, Bath: 1832, pp. 415-416, Richard H. Barker, *Mr. Cibber of Drury Lane* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1939), pp. 168-171, and Arthur Scouten, LS, 3, I, lxxxix-xciii.

[15] For exposition of the eight prints of "A Rake's Progress" (1735) see Paulson's HGW, I, 158-170. The subscription was announced in late 1733, but the paintings were not completed until mid-1734.

[16] Esther K. Sheldon, *Thomas Sheridan of Smock-Alley* (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton University Press, 1967), pp. 284-285, and Raymond C. Rhodes, *Harlequin Sheridan: The Man and the Legend* (Oxford: B. Blackwell, 1933), p. 79.

[17] Sheldon, p. 301.

[18] I am indebted to Prof. Edgar V. Roberts for pointing out this source to me, and for his help in identifying many of the tunes.]

[19] "Mr. Seedo's London Career and His Work with Henry Fielding," *Philological Quarterly*, XLV (January 1966), 185 and 189.

[20] See Bronson's article (above, n. 6) *passim*, where he mentions many of the songbooks.

BIBLIOGRAPHICAL NOTE

The facsimile of *The Harlot's Progress* (1733) is reproduced from the copy (Shelf Mark: 151783) in the Henry E. Huntington Library. The total type-page (p. 9) measures 155 x 115 mm. *The Rake's Progress* (ca. 1778-1780) is presented in type from a manuscript (Additional MS. 25997) in the British Library. Spelling, capitalization, and punctuation have been preserved, but colons and doubled colons used to indicate word divisions have been silently emended to hyphens or closed, and free-form brackets for stage directions have been standardized to parentheses.

THE HARLOT'S PROGRESS; OR, THE *RIDOTTO AL' FRESCO:*

A
Grotesque Pantomime Entertainment.
As it is perform'd by his Majesty's Company of Comedians
AT THE

THEATRE-ROYAL in *Drury-Lane*.

Compos'd by Mr. *Theophilus Cibber*, Comedian.

The SONGS made (to old Ballad Tunes) by a Friend.

Printed for the Benefit of *Richard Cross* the Prompter;
and Sold at the Theatre. 1733. [Price Six Pence.]

THIS
ENTERTAINMENT

Is Dedicated to the Ingenious

Mr. *H O G A R T H*,

(On Whose

Celebrated Designs it is Plan'd,)

*By his Well-wisher,
and obliged
Humble Servant,*

Theo. Cibber.

*Saturday, March
31st, 1733.*

Persons in the Harlot's Progress.

Harlequin,	Mr. <i>Le Brun</i> .
Beau <i>Mordecai</i> ,	Mr. <i>Stoppelaer</i> .
Old Debauchee,	Mr. <i>Berry</i> .
Justice <i>Mittimus</i> ,	Mr. <i>Mullart</i> .
Mons. <i>Poudre</i> ,	Mr. <i>Oates</i> .
Constable,	Mr. <i>Jones</i> .
Keeper,	Mr. <i>Burnet</i> .
Porter,	Mr. <i>Peploe</i> .
<i>Pompey</i> ,	<i>Y. Grace</i> .
Beadles,	{Mr. <i>Gray</i> .
	{Mr. <i>Wright</i> .
Miss <i>Kitty</i> ,	Miss <i>Raftor</i> .
Madam <i>Decoy</i> ,	Mrs. <i>Mullart</i> .
<i>Jenny</i> ,	Mrs. <i>Grace</i> .
Bess <i>Brindle</i> ,	Mr. <i>Leigh</i> .

Persons in the *Ridotto al' Fresco*.

Les Capricieux by Mr. *Essex* and Miss *Robinson*.
The *Hungarians* by Mr. *Houghton* and Mrs. *Walter*.
The *Fingalians* by Mr. *Lally Sen.* and Miss *Mears*.
Scaramouch, *Pierot*, and *Mezetin* by Mr. *Lally*, Junior, Mr. *Tench*, and Mr. *Stoppelaer*.
Ladies of Pleasure by Miss *Mann*, Miss *Atherton* and Miss *Price*.
The Marquis *de Fresco* by Monsieur *Arlequin en Chien*.

HARLOT'S PROGRESS;

OR THE

RIDOTTO AL FRESCO:

After the Overture, the Curtain rises;—the Scene represents an Inn; The Bawd, the Country Girl, the *Debauchee* and the Pimp, all rang'd as they are in the *first Print*.—The Parson on the Right Hand, reading the Letter, soon goes off——while the Bawd is persuading the Girl to go along with her, Harlequin appears at the Window, and seeing the Country Girl, jumps down, and gets into a Trunk which belongs to her, while the Bawd sings.

AIR I. What tho' I am a Country Lass.

*Let Country Damsels plainly nice,
In Home-spun Russet go, Sir;
While, Frolick we, chearful as wise,
More pleasing Transports know, Sir.
They dull and coy,
Refuse the Joy,
All bashful void of Skill-a:
We gay and free
To each fond He
Yield up our selves at Will-a.*

*At last our Youth and Charms decay'd,
Like old experienc'd Sinners,
We follow the procuring Trade,
And train up young Beginners.
Thus ample Gains,
Reward our Pains;
Then mock not our Profession,
Like Courtiers we,
Secure the Fee,
And laugh at the Transgression.*

After the Song, the Bawd beckons a Porter, orders him to take up the Trunk and follow her and the Girl, which he does, with Harlequin in it.— Then the *Debauchee* comes forward, who seems to be enamour'd with the Girl; the Pimp assures him he can procure her for him, upon which the *Debauchee* seems rejoic'd and sings in Praise of Women and Wine.

AIR II. *Brisk Tom and Jolly Kate.*

*Brisk Wine and Women are,
The Sum of all our Joy;
A Brimmer softens every Care,
And Beauty ne'er can cloy:
Then let us Drink and Love,
While still our Hearts are gay,
Women and Wine, by turns shall prove,
Our Blessings Night and Day.*

After the Song he follows her—the Pimp struts about and sings.

AIR III. *Maggy Lawther.*

*Pimping is a Science, Sir,
The only Mode and Fashion,
To Virtue bids Defiance, Sir,
'Tis the Glory of the Nation.
In City, Country, or in Court,
It is the Coup d'Grace, Sir;
If you your Patron's Vice support,
You need not fear a Place, Sir.*

*The Lawyer pimps to gain a Coif,
While Porters pimp for Hire;
Kind Betty serves his Worship's Wife,
The Page pimps for the Squire,
'Tis pimping gains a large Estate,
Makes Valets wear their Swords, Sir,
For Pimps oft look as big and great,*

As any Duke or Lord, Sir.

After the Song he follows the Debauchee.—The Scene changes to the Street; the Debauchee having found Harlequin in Company with Miss *Kitty*, turns her out of Doors, and the Pimp kicks out Harlequin; *Kitty* goes out in the greatest Distress—Harlequin by his Action signifies he's in Love, and is in doubt whether to hang or drown himself, or cut his Throat, &c. At length he resolves to follow her, and determines to dress himself like a smart *Cadet*, in order to address her: To accomplish which he strikes the Ground, and there rises a Dressing-Table fix'd in a Cloud, furnish'd with all necessary Appurtenances.—After he is drest, the Table vanishes and he goes out. The Scene changes to the Lodging that Beau *Mordecai* has provided for *Kitty*, whom he has just taken into high Keeping. (This Scene is taken from *the Second Print*) she is discovered lolling upon a *Settée*, attended by her Maid and Black-Boy, admiring the Grandeur of which she is possess'd, and then sings.

AIR IV. Oh! what Pleasures will abound.

*Who wou'd not a Mistress be,
Kept in Splendor thus like me?
Deckt in golden rich Array,
Sparkling at each Ball and Play!
Gaily toying,
Sweets enjoying
Foreign to that thing a Wife,
Flirting, flaunting,
Jilting, jaunting,
Oh the Charming happy Life!*

After the Song Harlequin creeps from under her Toilet, in the Habit of the *Cadet*, and courts Miss *Kitty*; she appears Coy at first, but at length yields to him.—Then sings.

AIR V. *Lad's a Dunce.*

Thus finely set out,

*I'll make such a Rout,
And top all the Rantipole Girls of the Town;
With Glances so bright,
Lords and Dukes I'll delight,
And make all the Rakes with their Ready come down,
The Stock-jobbing Cit,
For a hundred I'll hit,
While me he is rifling, I'll rifle his Purse;
With Saint-like Smile
I'll Zealots beguile,
And make the fond Hypocrite freely disburse.*

*Thus, thus in full Pow'r,
I'll sweeten, I'll sour,
I'll whindle, I'll bluster, I'll wheedle, I'll cant,
I'll bubble, I'll blind,
Make Fools of Mankind,
Each Cully shall think he's my only Gallant,
With such Supplies
To Grandeur I'll rise,
And revel in Pleasure, in Plenty and Ease,
While in the dark,
A favourite Spark,
I'll keep at my Call to enjoy when I please.*

After the Song they retire to the Bed; immediately is heard a knocking at the Door; the Maid looks out and perceives it to be the *Jew*, upon which she runs and tells her Mistress, who comes out with Harlequin in the utmost Confusion.—But she advises him to retire to the Bed, which he does; she sits down upon the *Settée*, and orders the Maid to let *Mordecai* in—when he enters he seems angry that she made him wait so long at the Door, but is soon pacify'd when he sees *Kitty* alone.—He sits down by her, and is very fond of her; then orders the Maid to get Tea, which she does—while they are drinking it, *Kitty* appears in Confusion, and makes Signs to the Maid to let Harlequin out; but while he is attempting to steal away, he accidentally drops his Sword and Cane, which surprizes the *Jew*, who turning about perceives Harlequin, upon which Miss *Kitty* in a Passion over-sets the Tea-

Table.—The *Jew* enrag'd, runs to secure the Door, and is in the greatest Passion with her, she laughs at him, and they sing the following *Duette*.

AIR VI. *Maidens as fresh as a Rose.*

Kitty. Farewell, good Mr. Jew;
 Now I hate your tawny Face;
 I'll have no more to do
 With you or any of your Race.
Jew. Begone, you saucy Jade,
 I will ne'er believe thee more;
 Follow the Drury Trade,
 Thou shalt ne'er deceive me more.
Kitty. Then take your self away,
 Since I have chous'd you well, you Cull;
 But come another Day,
 When you have got your Pockets full.
Jew. Be not so pert, my Dear,
 This Pride may shortly have a Fall,
 Soon shall I see or hear,
 Madam, in Bridewell, milling Doll.
Repeat. *Soon shall I see or hear, &c.*
She repeats with him. *Ne'er more will I come near,*
 Such a pitiful pimping Fool.

After the Song he turns her and her Maid out of Doors, then pursues Harlequin.—A Picture falls down, Harlequin jumps thro' the Hangings, and the Picture returns to its place and conceals him.—The Subject of the Picture, which was before an Historical Story, is now chang'd to a Representation of the *Jew* with Horns upon his Head.—While he stands in astonishment the other Picture changes likewise, and represents Harlequin and *Kitty* embracing—upon which the *Jew* runs out in the greatest surprize. Scene changes to the Street. Harlequin meets the *Jew*, who immediately draws; Harlequin catches him by the Leg, and throws him down, jumps over him, and runs off, the *Jew* pursues him.—The Scene changes to a poor Apartment in *Drury-Lane*. (This is taken from the Third Print) *Kitty* is discover'd sitting disconsolate by the Bedside, drinking of Tea, attended by

Bess Brindle (a Runner to the Ladies of Pleasure) Harlequin jumps in at the Window; she seems overjoy'd to see him—just as they are going to sit down to drink Tea, they hear a Noise without—Harlequin looks thro' the Key-hole, and discovers it to be the Justice, Constable, Watch, &c. He is very much surpris'd, and jumps into a Punch-Bowl that stands upon a Table, to hide himself—Justice *Mittimus* enters with the Constable, &c. the Watch seize *Kitty* and the Runner, and carry 'em off.—The Constable stays behind to pilfer what he can, during which, Harlequin creeps from under the Table; the Constable seeing him, goes to seize him, but he jumps thro' the Window and escapes—the Constable runs off.—The Scene changes to the Street. A melancholy Tune is play'd, while several Ladies of Pleasure (alias *unfortunate Women*) are led cross the Stage as going to *Bridewell*, with *Kitty* and her Maid, the Bawd, &c. Three Justices bring up the Rear.—Scene changes to *Bridewell*. The Women are discover'd all leaning in an indolent manner upon their Blocks.—The Keeper enters, and seeing them so idle, threatens to beat 'em—as they take up their Hammers and Beetles, and are going to beat, the Blocks all vanish, and in their stead appear Harlequin, Scaramouch, *Pierrot*, and *Mezetin*, each takes out his Lady to dance, and signify they'll go to the *Ridotto al Fresco*; the Keeper runs away frightened, they all dance off.—Scene changes to the Street. A great Number of People pass over the Stage, as going to the *Ridotto*, among whom appears the Marquiss *ae Fresco*, perform'd by the little Harlequin Dog.

The Scene changes to the *Ridotto al Fresco*, illuminated with several Glass Lustres, (the Scene taken from the place at *Vaux-Hall*) Variety of People appear in Masquerade, and a grand Comic Ballad is perform'd by different Characters to *English, Scotch, Irish* and *French* Tunes, which concludes the whole.

Then follows the Masque of the *Judgment of Paris*, &c.

FINIS.

The
Rake's Progress.

from W. Shaw.

The Rake's Progress.
("Hogarth's Series of Pictures Dramatised." P.G.P.)

25,997 British Museum

The Rake's Progress

Before the Curtain—Prefaratory Address.

To wake the Soul by tender strokes of Art
To raise the Genius & to mend the Heart
To make mankind in conscious virtue bold
Was Hogarth's wish while Rakewell's Tale he told,
And strongly painted in gradations nice,
The pomp of Folly, & the Shame of Vice,
Reach'd thro' the laughing Eye—the mended Mind,
And moral humour sportive art beguil'd;
The Walks of humour were his cast of style,
Which probing to the quick, yet makes us smile;
'Twas Comedy, his natural road to fame,
(Nor let me call it by a meaner name).
Where a beginning, middle & an End
Are aptly Join'd; where parts on parts depend,

Each made for each, as Bodies for their Soul,
So as to form one true & perfect whole,
Where a plain story to the Eye is told,
Which we conceive the moment we behold;
This we adopt, your Feelings to engage,
And bring his glowing Portraits on the Stage,
In action tell the workings of the mind
And paint the Various follies of Mankind,
Nor criticism the Attempt destroy,
If with pure Gold we mingle an alloy,
And his great Scenes where nature's self is shewn
Connect with trifling sketches of our own
Nor (to the moral Tale give ample Vigour)
Deny the aid of allegoric Figure;
But Vice & Virtue see this Mansion tread,
And in prelude tow'rds the Story lead,
Attentive view each action of our Rake,
And 'plaud the actor for the Painter's Sake.

Scene 1st

Enter Vice.

Recitative. Deck'd in the gaities of thoughtless Joy
Let jocund Laughter in each orbit beam
In mirth alone I passing time Employ
Attune my Voice & Pleasure is the Theme.
The Flowery maze of Pleasure is divine
And Mortals bow at Vice's dazzling Shrine.

Air.—From Virue's sluggish Rules be free,
Ye mortals who my Shrine adore,
Dance, Laugh & Quaff, & sing like me,
And dissipate the tasteless hour:

In frolic, pastime, Sport & Play
Revel in Joys your Lives away.

Enter Virtue.

Recitative.

Vice. But Virtue comes!—Offends my sickening Eye!

(Virtue touches the Scene & a Transparency of *Hogarth* appears with a Scroll in his hand on which is inscribed "*The Rake's Progress.*")

And Hogarth!—Moral Painter too I see!
In dark oblivion shall thy Semblance lie,
Hogarth & Virtue're enemies to me

(Approaches to Destroy the Transparency.)

Recitative.

Virtue. Forbear, forbear—by Hogarth is pourtray'd
The Fate of those thy precepts have betray'd,
As in a Mirror's seen each impious Joy,
That Courts the Victim only to destroy.
And look—(*Vice goes off.*) Appall'd Vice trembles at the Sound
In virtue only is true Pleasure found. (*Exit.*)

Before the Drop—Enter Virtue.

Air. Tune, "Mary's Dream."

Beware—nor lur'd by Vice's Arts,
A moment listen to her wiles,
He who from Virtue's path departs
In seas of trouble she beguiles;
This Hogarth's living pictures shew
View thoughtless man, by Vice undone,

A warning 'tis design'd for you,
Behold—& baneful pleasure Shun. (*Exit*)

Scene 2nd (No Music.)

A Loud knocking at Street Door

Enter *Starved Maid* O.P.—She goes across so slow that the Knocking increases; just before she gets to the Door it is burst open by *Rake* (a Youth from College) follow'd by *attorney*, *Upholsterer* & *Clown* *Servant*. *Rake* flourishes about, kicks against Closet Door, breaks it open. (Tune "Alteration") takes Keys from thence—Opens an Iron chest, assisted by *Clown*—*Rake* scatters Cash about from out of Bags—Lawyer having sat down & produced a Paper with the Word "Inventory" written at Top, begins to count Cash, pocketing some at opportunities; *Upholsterer* fetches a Ladder & goes to work to take down Tapestry. *Rake* breaks open Bureau, throws parchments about; seeming to look for one in particular. *Clown* having observed the *Lawyer* pocke[ts] some Cash, places himself so near *Lawyer*, that he puts the money into *Clown's* pocket, supposing to have put it into his own. A Knocking at the Door obliges *Clown* to go. *Taylor*, with a Roll of Black Cloth, is introduced by *Clown*, much ceremony between *Taylor* & *Clown*.—*Taylor* proceeds & measures *Rake*. *Clown* gets his fingers snipp'd for interfering. The Door having been left open—Enter *Starv'd Maid* with wood; & goes to the Fireplace; *Clown* then looking at *Upholsterer* at Work, the money from the raftor falls into *Clown's* mouth, at which he Spits & makes a piece of work as if hurt, puts his hand to his mouth & finding it is money Returns & holds up the flap of his coat to catch more. Enter P.S. *Mother* & *Daughter*, at sight of whom *Rake* stands aghast.—Girl approaches him. *Rake* turns from her—She retreats in Tears—*Mother* enraged shews Letters—*Girl* shews a Ring—*Rake* takes a handful of Guineas, offers *mother*—who rejects them, striking his hand, scatters them on the Ground; *Lawyer* Turns *Mother* & *Daughter* out, placing *Clown* with his back against the Door. *Rake* in great agitation, walks about, *Taylor* following him to finish measuring him: Lawyer picking up the money & pocketing some.—*Clown* points to *Rake*—who, on seeing *Lawyer* at it, takes Rolls of Parchment & beats *Lawyer* about the Head—

upon which *Clown* takes the Roll of Black Cloth & knocks it about *Taylor's* head, *Taylor* resists, *Upholsterer* on his Ladder Laughs—The Scuffle increases, in which they knock down the Ladder, *Upholsterer* falls—*Rake* & *Clown* turn them all out.

Scene 3^d

Enter Mother & Daughter

Duett—Tune—"An Old Woman Cloathed in Grey."

Mother. His Vows, ah! Why did'st thou believe?
He ne'er meant a promise to keep,
He talk'd but of Love to decieve,
Then Leave plunder'd Virtue to weep.
Yet Tears my Sad Chidings disarm,
For thy fault Pity pleadingly moves
In her Bosom Affection Shall warm
The Daughter she tenderly loves.

Daughter. Dear Parent, oh! Cease to complain
And heedfully hear thy lost Child
Go tell the false ear of my Swain
How deeply his Vows have beguil'd;—
Go tell him what sorrow I bear,
See yet if his heart feel my woe,
'Tis now he must heal my despair,
Or death will make pity too slow. *Exeunt.*

Scene 4th

Discovers all the *Characters* in Waiting at *Rake's* Levee. *Italian* Singing &c—*Clown* introduces *Van Butchel*, who displays a variety of his Articles.—*Van Butchel* Sings.

Song—See Martin dus his goods display—
 "Advice Two Guineas"—vat you say?
 "Big Ben—John Hunter—Duc d'Orleans—
 "Knows vat my regulations means;
 "De Gent I make of de aukward ninny,
 "But first to be sure I must touch de Guinea,
 "Den De Lane I vil make go dance de hay
 "And de old & decripid go jump away.

"Beware De Counterfiet if they should
 "Be imitate, as are all things good—
 "On de Guinea—for to abash bad men
 "I have write my name wid de author's Pen.
 "They'll cure you be sure if them once you lap on
 "Of all de complainings dat ever may happen,
 "De blind they'll make see to go dance the Hay,
 "And de Old & decripid vill jump away.

Enter *Rakewell* to whom they all pay Court &c

Medley.

Poet. To Rakewell, whose enlivening Features
 Pronounce him first of happy creatures
 By wealth a Cræsus 'self Created,
 This fair Epistle's Dedicated

(Tune
 Petition
 Poor Vulcan

Dance^g Mas^r. Look! Look! Look! (Spoke.)
 With my tun'd little Kit
 Every fancy I hit
 And merrily prance it
 And caper & Dance it
 With Ease, Elegance & Grace

(Tune
 Black Joke.)

Fenc.^g Mas^r. Ha! ha!—there I had him
 Carte & Fierce my Blade
 La! La!—there I bled him—

Damme!—See, he's dead.
Tol lol lol do

(Tune
Stoney Batter.)

Van But: Since 'mong your Friends I have gain'd me a
place
All who Gallows her vant, vy, I'll presently
trace
Not you (*to Bully*) for the Gallows is mark in
your Face
Vish you can't deny.

(Tune Tyburn Tree)

Bully. You Reptile! Scoundrel! Death! Damnation!
Say that again, & by my Soul

Gard.ⁿ My Garden plan I here unroll

Bully. I'll crush to atoms—Damme, Sirrah!

French.ⁿ While the Horn shall sound Ta, ran, tan, ta ra

Jockey. And Whip & Spur wins you the Bowl.—

(Tune
Finale
1st act
Poor Volcan)
(Hunting
Chorus
Poor Vulcan)

Chorus. Tune—"Ballance a Straw"

To Rake.—In us, noble Sir, your best Friends you behold
To each other Who will smile in your Face while we pocket your Gold
To Rake.—We'll write, -Sing, -Fence, Dance, Fight, Run, hunt,—all for
thee
(*To each Other* And plunder him fast as we can agree.
Shaking
hands.—)

Exeunt.

Scene 5th

Link Boys &c &c. The Characters in next Scene to pass from P.S. to O.P.

Rakewell—Well—but not full dup'd—*Chairmen* take great notice of him
bowing very low &c—*Clown*—loiters behind—seems well acquainted with

Constables—Chairmen Girls &c. Clown treats Constables with Beer & while drinking with them has his pocket picked.—During the Whole Scene the following Catch is Sung.

Catch.—"See Bob, See, the play is done."

Scene 6th

Some Ladies discoverd—One President.

Rake: Enters they all get up & greet him, some kiss him (a *Black Girl & waiter* on)—After much Ceremony they sit Other *Ladies & Gentlemen* Enter—When all are Seated

Omnes. A Song! A Song!— (NB: Plenty of Bottles & Glasses on.—)

Ladies Sing a Duett.

Rake: Drinks freely during the Duett—When Ended

Omnes. Bravo! Bravo!

Rake. Continues drinking freely—the actor must let his intoxication gradually increase. They all Sing.

a Catch. Ladies & Gentlemen, Silence,
Tomorrow night this play again
I say no more—Encore—Encore

during the Catch—*Ballad Singer* Enters & Joins them, Singing—"I say no more" &c—The Catch Ended the Scene Closes.

Scene 7th

Enter Bailiff & Follower.

Song, Bailiff.

Tim Touch behold, as smart a Blade
 As ere a writ expos'd to view
Who so genteely knows my Trade
 That I nabs my man, with a "How do you do"?
A Lodging Strong vil soon procure
 A Cage vere each may chaunt his lay,
From rambling keep your Rake Secure,
 Because I has such a taking Vay.

(2.)

E'en Ma'am, so proud of grand Parade
 Who at the Race-course makes her Bett
Or runs to Ball & Masquerade
 'Till she runs herself o'er Ears in debt
Tho 'my devoirs don't please her much,
 We meet, I every art essay
She's mine by a Necromantic touch
 Because I has such a taking Vay.

(3.)

Box-lobby Loungers to my will
 Obedient Yield, I change their Song
From bullying Bass to Treble Shrill
 E'en Dammes tremble on their Tongue;
I mimicry too; practice much,
 In taking off great Art display
I'm quite at home by a single touch,
 Because I has such a taking Vay. (*They Retire.*)

Enter *Sarah Young* & her *Servant Girl*, with a Box—on which is written "Sarah Young"—*Bailiffs*, come forward, look pryingly about—The Chair comes on P.S. *Bailiff* stops *Rake* and arrests him,—*Boy* Steals his Cane—*Sarah Young* pays the money for *Rake*, he kisses her hand, returns into

Chair & is carried back: She goes off O.P. supported by her *Girl*; having left the Contents of her Box on the Ground—The Shoe-Boy is picking them up, when *Clown* Enters, who reads, & recollects the name, disputes with *Boy* about the Contents of the Box, & seeing his Master's Cane claims it—a Scuffle ensues.—Whenever *Clown* attempts to Strike *Boy*—*Boy* throws his Stool in *Clown's* way over which he breaks his Shins—*Clown* has already a great Leak in his Hat, & finding a Muff in the Box, wears it, & apes the *Welchman* who is going to Court.

Scene 8th

Bells Ringing—Marrow Bones & Cleavers &c &c

Rake & Old Woman. Richly dress'd coming from Church. *Men Servants* in Rich Liveries—*Clown.*—*old Lady's maid Serv^t* &c all in favours.—*Parish Clerk* Bows very low—*Old Lady* Stops & makes him a present—*Marrow Bones & Cleavers* beg of *Rake* who throws money on the Ground, they Scramble for it. Company go off.—Tune during the Whole time—"Mind the Golden Rule." *Sarah Young*, on coming out of Church, faints against a Monument: Recovers to see them go off—Looks after them.—pause—Sings

Air.—Tune—"Mary's Lamentation."

I sigh, I lament me in vain
The Chill wind Re-echo's my moan;
Alas, what can equal my pain—
When I think that for ever he's gone.

My Eyes, when they're raised above,
View Birds as they wanton in Air
Sweet Birds!—Ye are coupled by Love
I weep & I sink in despair.

Tho' Affection be all turn'd to hate
And that Hate be the Sum of my woes

My fears will arise for his Fate,
I cannot divest me of those.

Base Man! know in Ages to come,
Thy falsehood detested Shall be
And when I am Cold in my tomb
Some Heart still shall sorrow for me. (*Bell Tolls.*)

What Visions now crowd on my Sight!
White Rob'd—with Eyes bent on the ground!
Ah! me—'tis a Funeral Rite—
I hear the deep Bell's solemn sound.

It tells me my Sorrows will close,
On Care's softest pillow all lye
The Grave will extinguish my woes
Then Sarah—prepare thee to die!

(*Exit.*)

Scene 9th

Servants attending—Enter *Rake* follow'd by *Clown*, who is ridiculously dress'd—*Rake* gives Orders to *Servants* and Exit—*Clown* follows a little way—then conceitedly returns & Sings to *Servants*.

Song. Clown.

Quite a Clod I came up my Shoes tied with a thong,
Lookd foolish—quite mulish I trudg'd it along,
And gaz'd like an Oaf at the wonderful throng,
That here so gay smart & brave are;
A ninny—the Twaddle—Lord quite a mere Hic
A terrible bore—quite a Thing—a Queer Stick—
But now, I'm the tippee—the dandy—the kick—
"Look here—here again—here again—here" (*Spoke*)

Tol de rol, de rol, la rol lol, la rol, lal la
Oh, Damme! I'm devilish clever.

(2.)

For Band Regulations to Butchells I pop
My ankles just hid by a Natty Boot-top,
Pig-tails are a Bore so I mount the neat Crop
 To appear the clean thing's my Endeavour
My negligent coat-cape proclaims me the Beau
Ease & Elegance always are habited so
I'm the tippee—the dandy—the kick too—heigho!
 "Look here &c &c &c

(3.)

The Girls all admire me—each fancy I please,
To one give a leer, tip the other a Squeeze,
Blow a kiss to the Third—for you see I'm all ease
 And each Whispers thanks for the favour
Boh—Damme!—an oath I so pleasantly swear
And for Duels—Bounce—Bang—let them fight me who dare
I'm the tippee—the Dandy—the Kick too—look there—
 There again &c &c— *Exit*

Noise without. Enter *Porter* with a *Washing Machine*, puts it down—
Enter *Beat'em*, pursued by *Washerwomen*, who beat him & break his
washing machine—Tear his *Bills &c &c* two or three of the *Women* hold
him, while an *Irish Washerwoman* sings the following *Song*.

Song Shelah O'Sudds—Tune "The Siege of Troy."

Och! Mr. Acrostic I hate your big notes,
In op'ning your Mouth, why you'd stop all our Thoats;
Wid Natty Men Milliners, Och! You'd be even,
And Starve all the Fair-Sex wid Men-Washer-Women.
But leave off such Nonsense 'tis better, my Joy,

Than let Shelah O'Sudds be widout her Employ;
We'll beat all your Beat'ems but give us fair-play
While wid Elbows & Fists we lather away.

Chorus. Sing Latherum, whack!—boderation, my Joy,
Let Shelah O'Sudds pray now have her employ
She'll beat all your Beat'ems but give her fair play
While wid Elbows & fists She Lather'd away.

(2.)

Wid your Saving & Soaping you make such a fuss,
But you save what is Ours for you steal it from us
'Bout your Beauty & Elegance, always are teizing,
By my Soul it's too pleasant, for long to be pleasing.
So leave off &c—

(3.)

To destroy our Endeavours to live is't you mean?
It's a black, dirty Job, tho' you do it so Clean
But a Wipe we must give you; agree, my dear Jewel—
And an Irish Shilaleh shall serve as the Towel.
So leave off &c

Exeunt—beating him off.

Scene 10th

One O'Clock in The Morning.

Two or More *Chairmen* playing at All-fours & Singing—

Catch.—"Agree, Agree, if not d'ye see."

Piano & Forte, according to the distance of the Watchman who calls the Hour, & when the Watchmen Enter they cover their Lanthorn with a Coat-Flap, & resume the Game when Watchman is gone. During this time the *Gamblers* who are in the next Scene, are to pass from P.S. to O.P. Sculkingly. *Rake* passes,—Stops,—pulls out his purse, shakes it, and Shutting one Eye—Signifies he had it from his One Ey'd Wife. *Catch Continues*—"Agree Agree" &c—Scene Closes.

Scene 11th

Discovers *Gamblers* at play. *Rake* Seated.

Catch—"Pass the Box, come pass it faster."—
or—"Rattle Dice, Rattle."—

Rake looses all his Cash—then his Watch—Sword Knee-Buckles — Snuff-Box—Ring—Everything. A *Man* Stands at his Back—supplies him with money on them 'till all is gone—When he Kneels.—Smoke is issuing thro' the Pannel, which does not alarm *Gamblers* in the least. Enter Watchmen—They continue playing & Singing—Scene Closes.

Scene 12th

Red Blinds waved Sometimes Quick Down then rais'd again. Watchmens Rattles heard, all bustle & noise at a little Distance. Enter some *Loosers* with *Characters of Suspicious look*—they produce Pistols to the Chagrin'd *Loosers*.—The *Loosers* take the Pistols.—Tune—"Let us take the Road."—They go off. Enter *watchmen* with Rattles. *Beadle, Mob* with Fire Engine (*Covent Garden or Hadley*.) Furniture carried across from the Gaming Room. Enter *Fire Men*.—Hose & Pipe conveyed across. Variety of *Characters* alarmed by Fire. A *Boy* carries a Feather-bed across—he falls down—Some *Characters* fall on it. NB: Confusion kept up as long as Necessary.

Scene 13th

Rake—is inhumanly dragg'd off by Bailiffs P.S.

Wife follows in great Agitation.

Enter Ballad-Singer

A Ballad Entitled & Call'd—"The Rake's Progress"—

Ballad. Tune "The Race-Horse."

See the Massy Chests Open'd, with Riches replete,
Plate, Jewels, & Rent-Rolls an ample Estate;
Bonds, Mortgages, Leases long buried are found,
Lawyers Servants & Tradesmen Attending around:
While with heart quite 'Elated, cheeks glowing with health,
Discarding his love, gazing pleas'd at his wealth,
Resolv'd each dull thought in gay pleasure to drown,
The Libertine Rakewell—first starts on the Town.

(2.)

His Levee attended by Bully & Sot
(Plighted vows to his fair Rustic Charmer forgot)
Poets, Dancers, Musicians, his Mansion Resort;
Boxers—Jockies, & Huntsmen, his patronage Court.
And now, in a Brothel, mid nymphs void of Fame,
Whom depravity's Render'd long Callous to Shame
He squanders his Fortune to infamy meet
And the Libertine Rakewell's the Dupe of Deceit.

(3.)

Now poverty Steals on her victim apace
And the gripe of Stern Law calls up dread in his Face,
'Till resolv'd to retrieve by his wants basely led [?]
He for Riches consents to deformity wed;

Then hurries to gaming to drive away thought,
Where Soon's dissipated the Wealth that she brought
For by Sharpers Surrounded—Each planning his Fall
The Libertine Rakewell's depriv'd of his all.

(4.)

And now in each feature we penury trace,
No longer health in his once blooming face,
Reproach in a Prison's dread gloom must he bear,
While discord & want drive the wretch to despair;
'Till of life fully Sated, pale, meagre, oppress'd,
By Friendship forsaken, All hell in his breast;
By Suicides aid from the world he retires
And the Libertine Rakewell unpitied Expires. (*Exit*)

Scene 14th

Chymist—Discover'd. *Tune "Welcome, Brother Debtor."* Enter *Goal*
O.P. Introducing Rake & Old Wife He Sits P.S. Enter Men & Women
Prisoners-OP.—All Sing.

Welcome, Welcome, Brother Debtor
 To this poor but merry place;
Where No Bailiff—Dun—or Setter,
 Dares to shew his frightful face.
But, kind Sir, as you're a Stranger
 Down your Garnish you must pay,
Or your Coat will be in Danger
 You must either Strip or pay.

Rake Strips his Coat off & turns out his Breeches Pockets;—At this
Period *Financer* drops his paper; it is picked up by another *Prisoner*, who
holds it so to Read that the audience may Read also. "Scheme to Pay the
National Debt."—

During the above Business—They all Sing—

Ne'er repine at your Confinement
For your Children or your Wife
Wisdom lies in true Resignment,
Thro' the various Scenes of life;
Every Island is a prison
Strongly guarded by the Sea
Kings & Princes for that Reason
Prisoners are as well as we.

Tune continues; but is Slower & Slower, till render'd as Dismal as possible. *Rake* takes a Pistol from his Pocket, which only the Audience observe—he in great agitation of Mind goes off, & the Report of a Pistol is heard—at which they all stand aghast.—Pause awhile.—

Enter Virtue.

Recitative.

Thus does the baneful influence of Vice
Onward to sure destruction man Entice;
In time be warn'd—Hope liberty to see
Benevolence & Pity'll set you free.

Chorus of Prisoners.

This let the Captive's Supplication be,
May Virtue & Benevolence soon set us free,
May we taste smiling liberty & tread her happy plain
Where Virtue & Benevolence in Concord reign.

Recitative. Virtue.

Then Vice discard & follow Virtue's train
View her Retreat & join her Sacred Strain.

Scene Changes.

Scene 15th

Cloud Descends: *Liberty* seated in the Center, with her Attributes; on her left hand a Vacant Seat which *Virtue* ascends, on her Right hand Benevolence, over whose head is a *Medalion* of *The King*—over that of *Virtue* one of the *Queen*.

Aerial Chorus.

Tho' Beauty & wealth may Unite,
To dispell from each Bosom dull care
'Tis in vain to expect true delight,
Unless *Virtue's* a Resident there.

Recitative. Virtue.

By Heav'n approv'd—by *Liberty* caress'd,
The Truly *Virtuous* are the truly bless'd.

Full Chorus.

This let the Captives &c—

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- 19. Susanna Centlivre, *The Busie Body* (1709).
- 22. Samuel Johnson, *The Vanity of Human Wishes* (1749), and two *Rambler* papers (1750).
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Transcriber's Notes:

Throughout the dialogues, there were words used to mimic accents of the speakers. Those words were retained as-is.

Errors in punctuations and inconsistent hyphenation were not corrected unless otherwise noted. For instance, sometimes there were

spaces after slashes ("/") and sometimes there were no spaces after slashes.

Some words appear to be misspelled, but they were not corrected since this book is so old (1733) and spellings have changed over the centuries.

The acute accent for Settee was changed to Settée throughout the text.

On the second page 1 "& and End" was replaced with "& an End"

On the second page 5 (there are two pages 5), "rake" was replaced with "Rake".

On the second page 5 the word "Clown" was italicized to make it consistent with other instances of the word.

On the second page 8 a period was added after "coming from Church".

On the second page 11, "SCENE 12" was replaced with "Scene 12"

On the second page 12, the word "Mansion", which was crossed out in the book was deleted.

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